

Olivier Gossner

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Research interests

Game theory; modelling, value, and strategic use of information; bounded rationality and complexity; finance and insurance.

Appointments

2014–	Professor, Department of Economics, <i>École polytechnique</i>
2008–	Full Professor, Department of Mathematics, <i>London School of Economics</i>
2005–	CNRS Research Director, CREST; current grade: <i>classe exceptionnelle</i>
2008–2014	Professor, <i>Paris School of Economics</i>
2005–2008	Visiting Professor, Kellogg School of Management, <i>Northwestern University</i>
2004–2005	Fellow, <i>Institute of Advanced Studies</i> , Jerusalem
1998–2005	CNRS Research Fellow
1996–1998	Fellow, CORE, <i>Université Catholique de Louvain</i>
1995–1996	Human Capital Mobility fellow, <i>Universitat Pompeu Fabra</i>

Education and qualifications

2004	Habilitation à diriger les recherches, <i>Université Paris Dauphine</i>
1996	PhD, <i>Université Paris 6</i> , <i>summa cum laude</i>
1995	Agrégation de mathématiques
1989–1993	Mathematics, <i>École Normale Supérieure</i> , Paris

Selected academic visits

April 2025	NYU Abu Dhabi
Nov. 2024	Brown University
March 2024	University of Southern California
Oct. 2022	Columbia University
Feb. 2011	New York University
Jan. 2010	Yale University

Publications

Journal articles

Market equilibrium with management costs and implications for insurance accounting, with Michael Florig, *The Geneva Risk and Insurance Review*, 51(1): 41–65, 2026 (first published online in 2024).

Matching with learning: a Bayesian assignment game approach, with Saeed Najafi-Zangeneh, *Mathematical Social Sciences*, 144: 102583, 2026 (available online).

Two-sided matching with bounded rationality: a stochastic framework for personnel selection, with Saeed Najafi-Zangeneh and Naser Shams-Gharneh, *Mathematics*, 13(19): 3173, 2025.

Double comptabilisation des frais de gestion sous Solvabilité II, with Michael Florig, *Risques*, 133: 125–130, 2023.

Attention please!, with Jakub Steiner and Colin Stewart, *Econometrica*, 89(4): 1717–1751, 2021.

High-sensitivity SARS-CoV-2 group testing by digital PCR among symptomatic patients in hospital settings, with Alexandra Martin, Alexandre Storto, Quentin Le Hingrat, Gilles Collin, Barbara André, Allison Mallory, Rémi Dangla, Diane Descamps, and Benoit Visseaux, *Journal of Clinical Virology*, 141: 104895, 2021.

Group testing against Covid-19, with Christian Gollier, *Covid Economics*, 2: 32–42, 2020.

Payoffs-beliefs duality and the value of information, with Michel de Lara, *SIAM Journal on Optimization*, 30(1): 464–489, 2020.

Preferences under ignorance, with Christoph Kuzmics, *International Economic Review*, 60(1): 241–257, 2019.

On the cost of misperception: general results and behavioral applications, with Jakub Steiner, *Journal of Economic Theory*, 177: 816–847, 2018.

A normalized value for information purchases, with Antonio Cabrales and Roberto Serrano, *Journal of Economic Theory*, 170: 266–288, 2017.

The complexity of interacting automata, with Penélope Hernández and Ron Peretz, *International Journal of Game Theory*, 45(1–2): 461–496, 2016.

Entropy and the value of information for investors, with Antonio Cabrales and Roberto Serrano, *American Economic Review*, 103(1): 360–377, 2013.

Finite-sample exact tests for linear regressions with bounded dependent variables, with Karl H. Schlag, *Journal of Econometrics*, 177(1): 75–84, 2013.

Impermanent types and permanent reputations, with Mehmet Ekmekci and Andrea Wilson, *Journal of Economic Theory*, 147(1): 162–178, 2012.

Performing best when it matters most: evidence from professional tennis, with Julio González-Díaz and Brian W. Rogers, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 84(3): 767–781, 2012.

Reasoning-based introspection, with Elias Tsakas, *Theory and Decision*, 73(4): 513–523, 2012.

Simple bounds on the value of a reputation, *Econometrica*, 79(5): 1627–1641, 2011.

Ability and knowledge, *Games and Economic Behavior*, 69(1): 95–106, 2010.

When is the lowest equilibrium payoff in a repeated game equal to the minmax payoff?, with Johannes Hörner, *Journal of Economic Theory*, 145(1): 63–84, 2010.

Information independence and common knowledge, with Ehud Kalai and Robert Weber, *Econometrica*, 77(4): 1317–1328, 2009.

Informationally optimal correlation, with Rida Laraki and Tristan Tomala, *Mathematical Programming*, 116(1–2): 147–172, 2009.

- Entropy bounds on Bayesian learning, with Tristan Tomala, *Journal of Mathematical Economics*, 44(1): 24–32, 2008.
- Secret correlation in repeated games with imperfect monitoring, with Tristan Tomala, *Mathematics of Operations Research*, 32(2): 413–424, 2007.
- Coordination through De Bruijn sequences, with Penélope Hernández, *Operations Research Letters*, 34(1): 17–21, 2006.
- Empirical distributions of beliefs under imperfect observation, with Tristan Tomala, *Mathematics of Operations Research*, 31(1): 13–30, 2006.
- Informational cascades elicit private information, with Nicolas Melissas, *International Economic Review*, 47(1): 297–325, 2006.
- Optimal use of communication resources, with Penélope Hernández and Abraham Neyman, *Econometrica*, 74(6): 1603–1636, 2006.
- On the consequences of behavioral adaptations in the cost-benefit analysis of road safety measures, with Pierre Picard, *Journal of Risk and Insurance*, 72(4): 577–599, 2005.
- Dynamiques de communication, with Penélope Hernández and Abraham Neyman, *Revue économique*, 55(3): 509–516, 2004.
- On the complexity of coordination, with Penélope Hernández, *Mathematics of Operations Research*, 28(1): 127–140, 2003.
- Positive value of information in games, with Bruno Basset, Marco Scarsini, and Shmuel Zamir, *International Journal of Game Theory*, 32(1): 17–31, 2003.
- Strategic learning in games with symmetric information, with Nicolas Vieille, *Games and Economic Behavior*, 42(1): 25–47, 2003.
- How to play with a biased coin?, with Nicolas Vieille, *Games and Economic Behavior*, 41(2): 206–226, 2002.
- Repeated communication through the mechanism ‘and’, with Nicolas Vieille, *International Journal of Game Theory*, 30(1): 41–60, 2001.
- Comparison of information structures, *Games and Economic Behavior*, 30(1): 44–63, 2000.
- Secure protocols or how communication generates correlation, *Journal of Economic Theory*, 83(1): 69–89, 1998.
- Protocoles de communication robustes, *Revue économique*, 48(3): 685–695, 1997.
- Overlapping generations games with mixed strategies, *Mathematics of Operations Research*, 21(2): 477–486, 1996.
- The folk theorem for finitely repeated games with mixed strategies, *International Journal of Game Theory*, 24(1): 95–107, 1995.

Books

Introduction aux sciences économiques, with Jean-Baptiste Michau and Vincent Rollet, Economica, 2024.

Chapters in collective works

Repeated games with complete information, with Tristan Tomala, in Robert A. Meyers (ed.), *Encyclopedia of Complexity and Systems Science*, Springer, pp. 7616–7630, 2009. Subsequent editions in *Computational Complexity: Theory, Techniques, and Applications*, pp. 2620–2634, 2012, and *Complex Social and Behavioral Systems: Game Theory and Agent-Based Models*, pp. 139–156, 2020.

Editorial work

Special issue in honor of Abraham Neyman, with Ori Haimanko and Eilon Solan, *International Journal of Game Theory*, 45(1–2): 3–9, 2016 (editorial).

Preprints and working papers

Comparative statics of information acquisition and risk aversion, with Antonio Cabrales, Gregorio Curello, and Roberto Serrano, arXiv:2609.12149, 2026.

Direct representations for interim correlated rationalizability, with Rafael Veiel, arXiv:2607.21851, 2026.

Strategic type spaces, with Rafael Veiel, arXiv:2606.08297, 2026.

Unintended consequences of German stock delisting legislation, with Michael Florig, CREST Working Paper 2023-01, 2023.

Rationalizable outcome distributions: a Markov characterization, with Rafael Veiel, SSRN preprint 4253899, 2022.

Unpublished work

The robustness of incomplete penal codes in repeated interactions, Working paper, 2020.

The value of information in zero-sum games, with Jean-François Mertens, Working paper, June 2020 version.

Efficiency in the repeated prisoner’s dilemma with imperfect private monitoring, with Kyna Fong, Johannes Hörner, and Yuliy Sannikov, Working paper, 2011.

Honours and academic service

Distinctions

2025	Chevalier des Palmes Académiques
2024	Fellow of the Econometric Society

Editorial appointments

2013–2026	Advisory Editor, Games and Economic Behavior
2008–2020	Associate Editor, Mathematics of Operations Research
2011–2015	Associate Editor, Operations Research Letters
2006–2014	Associate Editor, Theory and Decision

Conference and seminar organisation

2025–	Paris Game Theory Festival, co-founder and co-organizer.
2008–	Transatlantic Theory Workshop, co-founder and co-organizer.
2008	Workshop on Recent Advances in Repeated Games, Stony Brook, co-organizer
2005	16th Conference on Game Theory and Applications, Stony Brook, organizer
2008–2010	Roy Seminar, co-organizer
1998–2004	Paris Game Theory Seminar, co-organizer

Academic administration

2022–	Vice President of the Game Theory Society, for communications
2015–2021	Head of the Economics Department, <i>École polytechnique</i> Programme creation: Bachelor in Mathematics and Economics; MScT programmes in Economics, Data Analytics and Corporate Finance, and Smart Cities and Urban Planning; Master and PhD programmes in Economics.
2012–2014	Paris School of Economics board member
2008–2011	CNRS commission member, nominated by the minister Valérie Pécresse
2009–2011	Deputy Head of Department for Research, Department of Mathematics, LSE
2008–2012	Member of the Game Theory Society council

Research funding and fellowships

2024–2029	SInfoNiA (Strategic Information: New Directions and Applications), Principal Investigator. European Research Council (ERC) Advanced Grant awarded in 2024; funded by UK Research and Innovation (UKRI).
2023–2028	PolArIs, Principal Investigator; French Ministry of Defence, through CIEDS.
2012–2014	LabEx OSE (Ouvrir la Science Économique), co-lead of the research theme on individual, strategic and social behaviour.
2010–2013	STICERD grant “Exact nonparametric tests for linear regressions – theory and applications”, Principal Investigator
2005–2008	US National Science Foundation, grant SES-0550993 “Summer Program on Game Theory and Economics”
2004–2008	ACI Jeunes Chercheurs, Principal Investigator
1997–1999	Swiss National Science Foundation, individual fellowship
1995–1997	Marie Curie individual fellowship

Teaching

Current teaching

2019–	Introduction to Economics (550 students), École polytechnique
2014–	Advanced Game Theory, M2 Master in Economics
2008–	Game Theory, undergraduate course, London School of Economics

Previous teaching

2025–2026	Foundations of Financial Markets, NYU Abu Dhabi
2025	Intermediate Microeconomics, NYU Abu Dhabi
2021–2025	Corporate Finance, master's course, École polytechnique
2021–2023	Complex Analysis, undergraduate course, London School of Economics
2016–2025	Microeconomics, M1, Master in Economics
2014–2022	Game Theory, École polytechnique
2011–2017	Dynamical Systems and Chaos Theory, undergraduate course, London School of Economics
2008–2010	Probability for Finance, undergraduate course, London School of Economics
2007–2014	Topics in Game Theory, Master Analyse et politique économiques, graduate course
2005–2008	Mathematical Methods for Management Decisions, MBA, Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University
2005–2008	Statistical Methods for Management Decisions, MBA, Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University
2004–2006	Decision Analysis and Game Theory, DEA Analyse et politique économiques, graduate course
2002–2005	Decision Theory and Game Theory, École Nationale des Ponts et Chaussées
2002–2005	Information Economics, DEA Optimisation, jeux et modélisation en économie, graduate course
2001	Microeconomic Theory, European Doctoral Program in Quantitative Economics, CORE, graduate course
2000	Strategic Use of Information, DEA Mathématiques appliquées aux sciences économiques, graduate course
2000–2001	Game Theory and Strategic Thinking, École des Mines de Nancy
1999	Information Economics, DEA Optimisation, jeux et modélisation en économie, graduate course
1999	Stochastic Processes and Applications, Université Paris Dauphine